THE UNION PARLIAMENT, PRESIDENT AND JUDICIARY

Class 8 Civics | Sample notes

1. LOK SABHA – Lower House of Parliament

- Members are **directly elected** by the people.
- Term: **5 years**, unless dissolved earlier.
- Presiding officer: the **Speaker**.
- A member must be at least **25 years** old.

2. RAJYA SABHA – Upper House of Parliament

- Members are elected by the members of the **State Legislative Assemblies**.
- It is a **permanent house** and cannot be dissolved.
- A member's term is **6 years**; one-third of the members retire every **2 years**.
- Presiding officer: the **Vice-President** of India.
- A member must be at least **30 years** old.

3. THE PRESIDENT – Head of the State

- Elected by an **electoral college** of elected members of Parliament and the State Legislative Assemblies.
- Term: **5 years**.
- Must be at least **35 years** old.
- Is the Supreme Commander of the **armed forces**.

4. SUPREME COURT – Highest court of India

- It is located in **New Delhi**.
- Its judges are appointed by the **President**.
- Judges retire at the age of **65**.
- It protects the **Fundamental Rights** of citizens.
- It is called the **guardian of the Constitution**.

QUICK COMPARISON

- Lok Sabha = people's house (5 years, Speaker)
- Rajya Sabha = permanent house (6 years, Vice-President)
- The President = head of the State (5 years, age 35)
- Supreme Court = guardian of the Constitution (retire at 65)